

Cat Inappropriate Elimination Vet Cleared — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

LITTER BOX ASSESSMENT

- ☐ **Count your litter boxes and add one more than the number of cats in your home to eliminate territorial competition and reduce avoidance behavior.:** Count your litter boxes and add one more than the number of cats in your home to eliminate territorial competition and reduce avoidance behavior.
- ☐ **Replace any standard commercial litter box with a 70-quart storage tote so your cat can turn around fully without touching the sides and feel secure inside.:** Replace any standard commercial litter box with a 70-quart storage tote so your cat can turn around fully without touching the sides and feel secure inside.
- ☐ **Remove the cover from any hooded litter box and observe whether your cat's elimination behavior changes over the next week.:** Remove the cover from any hooded litter box and observe whether your cat's elimination behavior changes over the next week.
- ☐ **Place two litter boxes side by side with different litter types and watch which one your cat consistently chooses to determine substrate preference.:** Place two litter boxes side by side with different litter types and watch which one your cat consistently chooses to determine substrate preference.

STRESS TRIGGER IDENTIFICATION

- ☐ **Review every environmental change in your home over the last 60 days including new pets, houseguests, moved furniture, or new cleaning products used.:** Review every environmental change in your home over the last 60 days including new pets, houseguests, moved furniture, or new cleaning products used.
- ☐ **Identify whether your cat eliminates near doors, windows, or on your bed to determine if the problem is territorial anxiety or owner-absence stress.:** Identify whether your cat eliminates near doors, windows, or on your bed to determine if the problem is territorial anxiety or owner-absence stress.
- ☐ **Check for neighborhood cats visible through windows more frequently as territorial intruders can trigger stress-based house soiling.:** Check for neighborhood cats visible through windows more frequently as territorial intruders can trigger stress-based house soiling.

- ☐ **Place litter boxes in quiet, low-traffic areas away from food bowls and loud appliances where your cat won't feel cornered or ambushed.:** Place litter boxes in quiet, low-traffic areas away from food bowls and loud appliances where your cat won't feel cornered or ambushed.

SYSTEMATIC DIAGNOSTIC PROCESS

- ☐ **Change only one litter box variable at a time and wait a full 5-7 days before evaluating whether the behavior has improved.:** Change only one litter box variable at a time and wait a full 5-7 days before evaluating whether the behavior has improved.
- ☐ **Keep a written log of every change you make including dates so you can accurately track what works and what doesn't.:** Keep a written log of every change you make including dates so you can accurately track what works and what doesn't.
- ☐ **Start testing variables in this order:** box number, then box size, then box type (covered versus uncovered), then litter type, then location.
- ☐ **Rule out medical causes by ensuring bloodwork and urinalysis were completed within the last six months before assuming the problem is behavioral.:** Rule out medical causes by ensuring bloodwork and urinalysis were completed within the last six months before assuming the problem is behavioral.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.